

Unit 5: Sīn, jīm and gāf

سین، جیم، گاف

1 In this unit

The toothed sīn family; the bowl-shaped jīm family; گ as kāf with an extra stroke.

How long: About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.



2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
س	sīn سین 's' in sun	three teeth right to left, then the bowl	shīn
ش	shīn شین 'sh' in shop	three teeth right to left, then the bowl; the dots last	sīn
ج	jīm جیم 'j' in jam	small head stroke leftwards, then the round bowl below; dot last	che
چ	che چے 'ch' in chair	small head stroke leftwards, then the round bowl below; dots last	jīm
گ	gāf گاف 'g' in go	base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top	kāf

3 How to use the sheets

- Trace and write:** one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
- Look-alikes:** circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
- Join the letters:** standing letters into a joined word.
- Read and match:** word to meaning.
- Reading practice:** words, sentences, story.
- Dictation:** the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
- Unit check:** 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- Praise effort:** "you started on the right", "good dots". One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time's letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.